Following two months of a sustained opposition agitation launched by the students and joined in by a wide cross section of Bangladesh society, President Ershad resigned on 6 December and handed over power to Mr Shahabud-din Ahmed, the chief justice of the Bangladesh Supreme Court, who assumed office as the acting president of Bangladesh.

Later, after the elections were held, the Indian government stated:

Elections for Parliament were held on 27 February 1991. The restoration of the democratic rights of the people of Bangladesh was a welcome development and India is looking forward to working closely with a democratically elected government in Bangladesh.

Patwardhan said Ershad did not know about Operation Farewell until 11 December 1990 when he was placed under house arrest. This surprise move by the interim government launched a further crackdown against Ershad's close aides. Former Vice President Moudud Ahmed, Prime Minister Kazi Zafar Ahmed and Foreign Minister Anisul Islam Mahmud were all picked up by the security forces.

'I think Nasiruddin Ahmed, commander of army intelligence, informed Ershad about the R&AW operation. I learnt a little later that Er-shad was shocked. He wanted to know how the operation was executed and whether the counterespionage unit under his presidency was totally defunct. It was actually difficult for him to believe that we had played the game so brilliantly and with so much secrecy. We learnt later that Ershad even enquired about the Indian intelligence officers operating in Bangladesh. His trusted lieutenants had no names or faces to share/ Patwardhan told me.